

LEAFBIRDS

The fruit-eating birds of the family Chloropseidae occur in forests in southeastern Asia. They use their brush-tipped tongue to take nectar, with which they supplement their diet. Male leafbirds are characteristically green, with a blue or black throat.

20 cm
8 in

ORANGE-BELLIED LEAFBIRD

Chloropsis hardwickei
This melodious bird inhabits the forest canopy at high altitudes, in a range from the Himalayas to the Malay Peninsula.

WHYDAH AND RELATIVES

African whydah birds and related indigobirds of the family Viduidae are cuckoo-like brood parasites of waxbills. The mouthparts and begging behaviour of the chicks usually resemble those of the host chicks, thus fooling the host parents.

12–38 cm
4¾–15 in

EASTERN PARADISE WHYDAH *Vidua paradisaea*

Typical of whydahs, breeding males of this E. African species have extraordinarily long tail feathers, which they use in display flights.

FLOWERPECKERS

These dumpy birds of the family Dicaeidae are related to the sunbirds from tropical Asia and Australasia. Largely fruit-eating, like sunbirds, they take nectar from flowers. The flowerpeckers differ in having a shorter bill.

MISTLETOEBIRD *Dicaeum hirundinaceum*

This Australian flowerpecker has a small gut to process mistletoe berries rapidly, and plays an important role in dispersing seeds of this parasitic plant.

10–11 cm
4–4¼ in

WAXBILLS AND RELATIVES

Consisting of small, highly gregarious, often brightly coloured seed-eaters, the family Estrildidae occurs in tropical Africa, Asia, and Australia. Many birds live in grassland or open woodland and build dome-like nests. Both parents share parental duties.

14 cm
5½ in

PURPLE GRENADIER

Uraeginthus ianthinogaster
An E. African bird of dry woodland, the purple grenadier belongs to a genus of predominantly blue waxbills.

10 cm
4 in

GREEN-BACK TWINSPOT

Mandingoa nitidula
Found in western to southern Africa, this thicket-dwelling twinspace has white-spotted underparts and is more secretive than other waxbills.

SCALY-BREADED MUNIA

Lonchura punctulata
This bird is common in S. Asian scrub. Male and female are alike in appearance.

10 cm
4 in

ZEBRA FINCH *Taeniopygia guttata*

Native to the drier parts of Australia, the zebra finch is a popular cagebird around the world.

10 cm
4 in

COMMON WAXBILL

Estrilda astrild
Abundant throughout Africa, this tiny waxbill, like related species, is a restless, flocking bird of open land, feeding on grass seeds.

12 cm
4¾ in

RED-THROATED PARROTFINCH *Erythrura psittacea*

Parrotfinches are mostly green-bodied waxbills from S.E. Asia to the Pacific Ocean. This species occurs in grasslands of the island of New Caledonia.

blackish
bill

black and white
"scaly" belly

18 cm
7 in

WHITE-THROATED DIPPER *Cinclus cinclus*

Widespread through temperate Eurasia, the white-throated dipper breeds near fast-flowing streams but may move to slower-flowing rivers in winter.

JAVA SPARROW *Lonchura oryzivora*

This vulnerable species from Java and Bali frequents farmland and feeds on cereal crops. It has been hunted as a rice pest and for the pet trade.

12 cm
4¾ in

GREEN-WINGED PYTILIA *Pytilia melba*

Male *Pytilia* waxbills have red splashes on their wings. This African species is host to the paradise whydah (*Vidua paradisaea*), a brood parasite.